

BSEP English AFCT Word Knowledge: Parts of Speech

Lesson for Soldiers Preparing for the AFCT

By: Dr. Kaira Bullock

Agenda:

- Complete Quiz#6
- Go over Word Knowledge Sentences for vocabulary words 150 — 185 (Homework from Quiz #5)
- Briefly discuss the Word Knowledge Parts-of Speech for the AFCT exam.
- Complete Applying Knowledge Activity (For Parts-of Speech)
- Give students the BSEP English Comprehensive Review Activity – R4. We will discuss in class tomorrow if we are here or whenever we return!!!
- Questions and Answers if time permits

What is Part of Speech?

- A part of speech tells how a word is used in a sentence.
- AFCT Tip: Identify the role of the word before choosing an answer.

Nouns

- **Definition:** Person, place, thing, or idea.
- **Example:** The soldier showed courage.
- **Context Clue:**
'soldier' = person,
'courage' = idea.

Verbs

- **Definition: Action or state of being.**
- **Example: The unit marches daily.**
- **Context Clue: 'marches' shows action.**

Adjectives

- **Definition:**
Describes a noun.
- **Example:** The mission was dangerous.
- **Context Clue:**
'dangerous'
describes mission.

Adverbs

- **Definition:**
Describes
verb/adjective.
- **Example:** He
moved quickly.
- **Context Clue:**
'quickly' describes
how he moved.

A blue speech bubble graphic with a tail pointing towards the bottom left. The text "AFCT Strategy" is written in white inside the bubble. The background of the slide features faint, curved, concentric lines in a light gray color.

AFCT Strategy

- 1. Identify part of speech
- 2. Replace word with synonym
- 3. Eliminate wrong answers
- 4. Use context clues

Practice Question 1

- The soldier gave a terse response.
- What does 'terse' mean?
- A. Long
- B. Brief
- C. Angry
- D. Loud

Answer 1

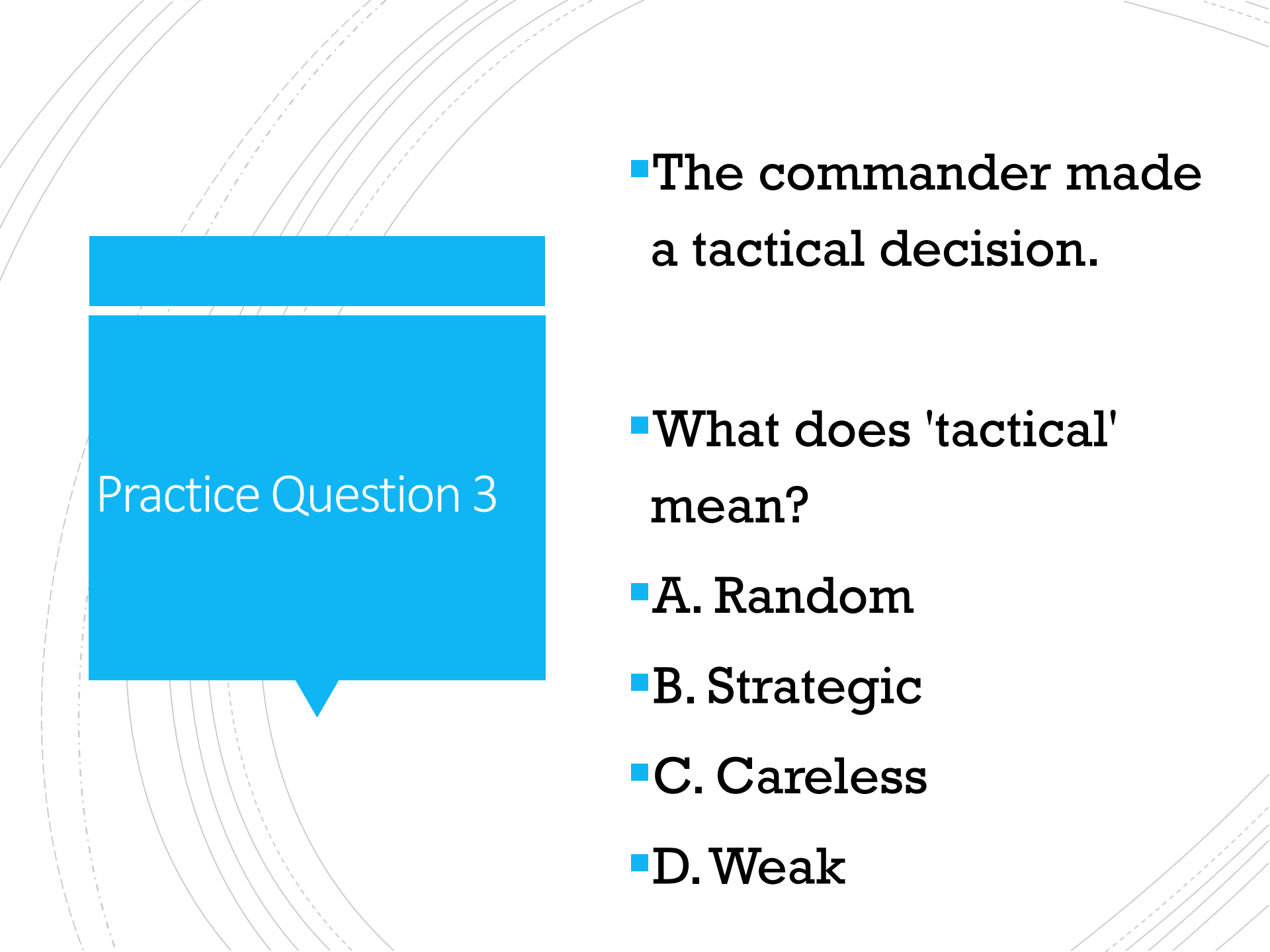
- **Correct Answer: B**
- **Explanation:**
'Response'
suggests speaking
→ 'terse' means
short or brief.

Practice Question 2

- The plan was flawed due to a hidden kink.
- What does 'kink' mean?
- A. Success
- B. Flaw
- C. Plan
- D. Victory

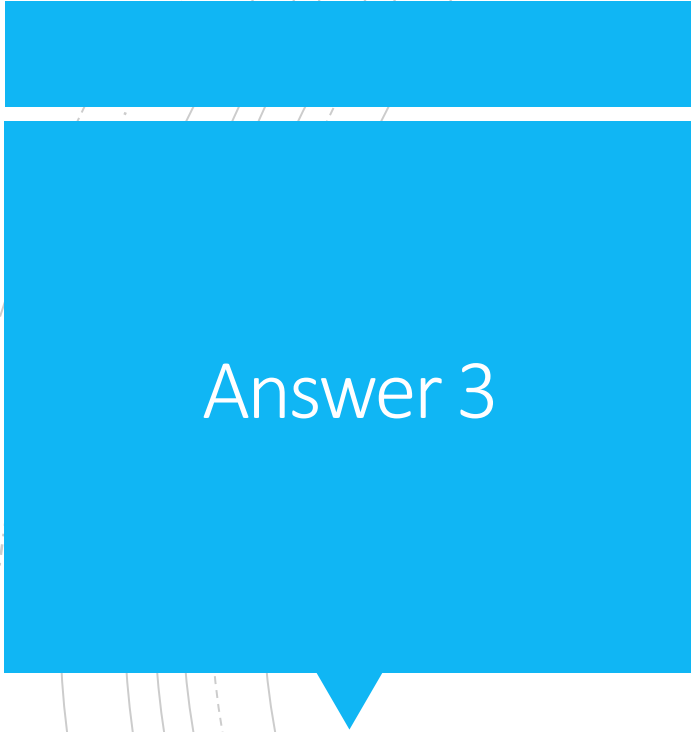
Answer 2

- **Correct**
Answer: B
- **Explanation:**
'flawed'
signals a
problem →
kink = flaw.



Practice Question 3

- The commander made a tactical decision.
- What does 'tactical' mean?
- A. Random
- B. Strategic
- C. Careless
- D. Weak



Answer 3

- **Correct Answer: B**
- **Explanation:**
'commander' +
decision →
planned/strategic.

Additional Tips to
Help Distinguish
the Part of Speech
a Word is...

- Using the words "a," "the," or "to" in front of a vocabulary word can help determine whether a word is a noun, verb, or adjective.
- Here's how you can use these words to distinguish between the parts of speech:

CORE STRATEGY
(BIG IDEA)

- **THE “A / THE / TO” TRICK**
- **TO = VERB (action)**
- **A / THE = NOUN (thing/person)**
- **Describes = ADJECTIVE**

NOUN VISUAL
NOUN = PERSON,
PLACE, THING, IDEA

- **Examples:**
 - a scapegoat
 - the scowl
 - a ritual
- 💡 **Visual idea: Picture of a soldier being blamed (scapegoat)**

VERB VISUAL
VERB = ACTION

■ Examples:

- to suppress

- to vex

- to engulf

- 💡 Visual idea:

Soldier stopping
chaos (suppress)

ADJECTIVE
VISUAL
ADJECTIVE =
DESCRIBES

- **Examples:**
 - tactical plan
 - terse response
 - valorous soldier
-  **Visual idea:**
**Soldier with
medals
(valorous)**

A blue speech bubble graphic with a tail pointing downwards and to the right. It contains the text "MILITARY APPLICATION" in white, uppercase letters.

MILITARY APPLICATION

- Orders must be **terse** (clear)
- Leaders must **synthesize** information quickly
- Teams must not **vacillate**

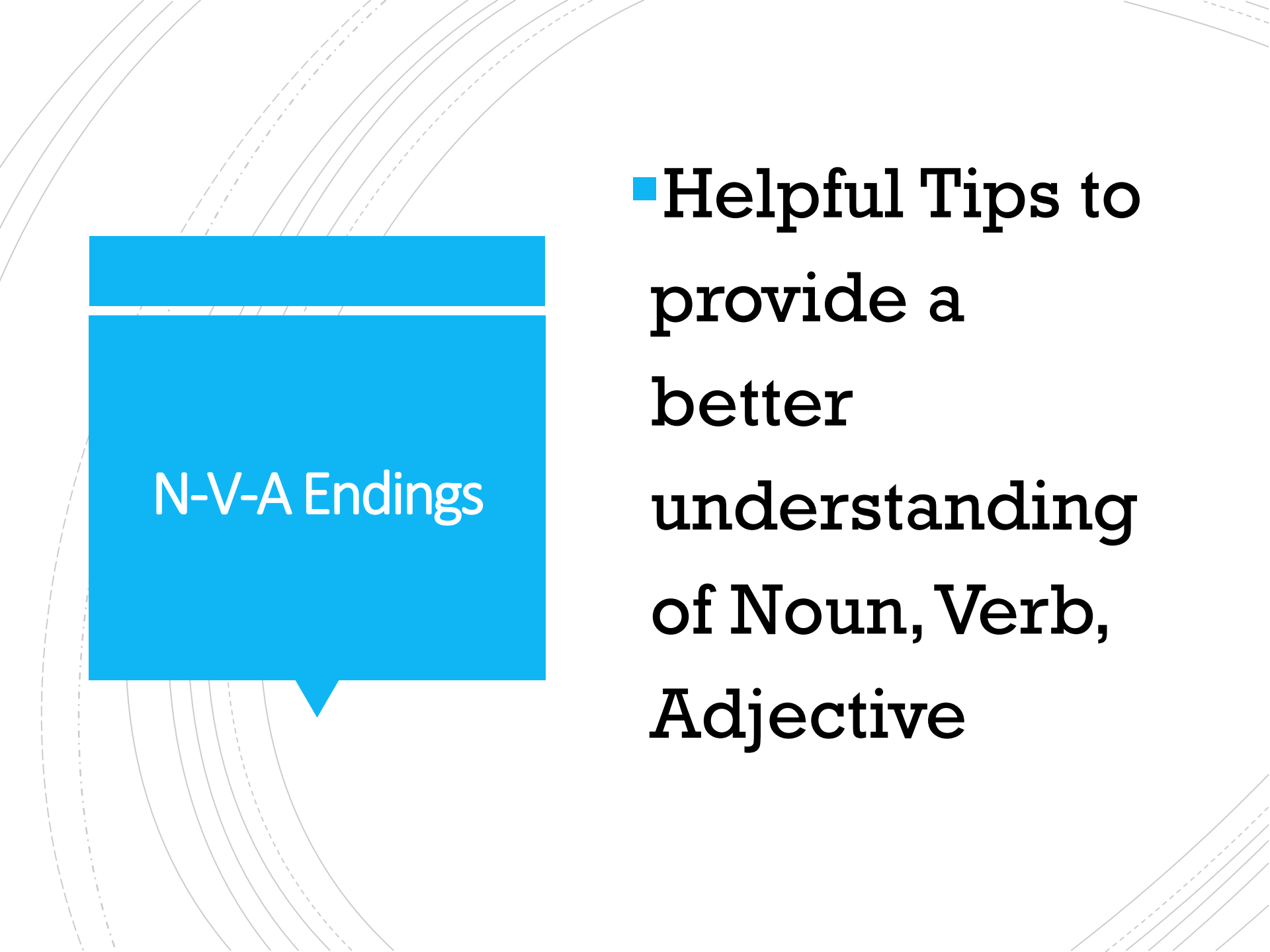
ADDITIONAL TIPS
SUMMARY WHAT
THIS MEANS IN
SHORT

- 1. Nouns: "A" or "the" in front of the word: If you can place "a" or "the" in front of the word and it makes sense in a sentence, the word is likely a noun.
- 2. Verbs: "To" in front of the word: If placing "to" in front of the word forms a valid infinitive verb (e.g., "to run," "to eat"), then the word is likely a verb.
- 3. Adjectives: "A" or "the" in front of a noun it describes: If you can place "a" or "the" in front of a word and it describes a noun, the word is likely an adjective.

A blue speech bubble graphic with a white border. The text inside is white. The background of the slide features faint, curved, concentric lines in the top left and bottom right corners.

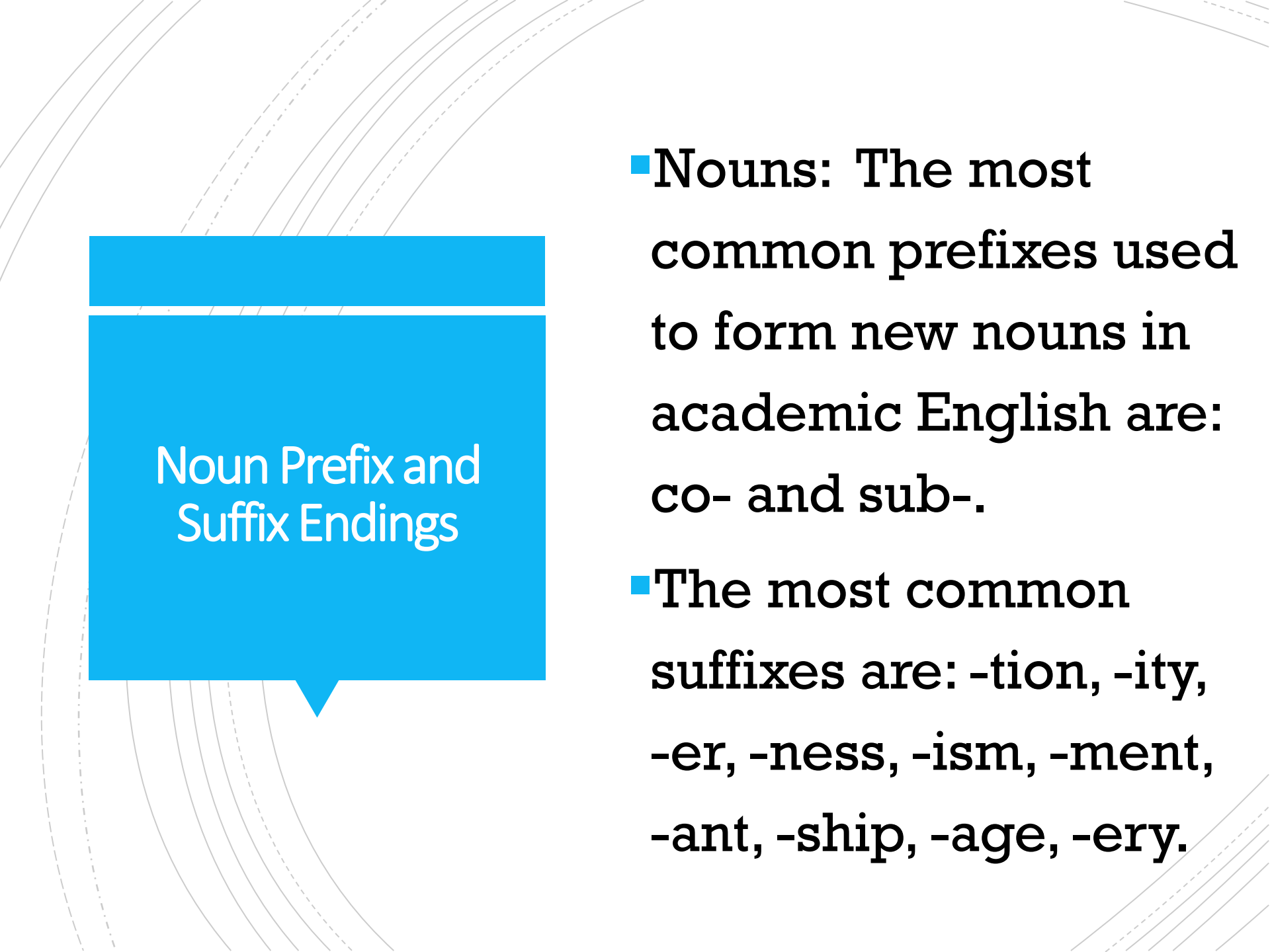
AFCT TEST TIP
If stuck:

- Add **“to”**
- Add **“a/the”**
- Ask: **“Does it describe?”**

The background of the slide features several thin, curved lines in light gray and white, creating a sense of motion and depth. A large, solid blue shape, resembling a speech bubble or a stylized letter 'N', is positioned on the left side of the slide. Inside this blue shape, the text 'N-V-A Endings' is written in white.

N-V-A Endings

- **Helpful Tips to
provide a
better
understanding
of Noun, Verb,
Adjective**



Noun Prefix and Suffix Endings

- **Nouns:** The most common prefixes used to form new nouns in academic English are: co- and sub-.
- The most common suffixes are: -tion, -ity, -er, -ness, -ism, -ment, -ant, -ship, -age, -ery.

Regular Verb Endings

- Regular verbs are conjugated by adding either "-d," "-ed," "-ing," or "-s" to its base form, unlike irregular verbs which have special rules for conjugation.
- A regular verb is also a verb whose simple past and past participle are formed by adding the suffix “-ed” (e.g., “walk” becomes “walked”).
- Regular verbs are verbs whose past tense versions are formed by adding an -ed to the end, such as 'walk,' 'climb,' 'decide,' 'describe,' 'drop,' 'want,' 'call,' and 'beg.' A simple past sentence contains only the past tense verb, as in 'She walked to school.'
- The majority of English verbs are regular.

Typical Adjective Endings (Suffix)

- Most common adjectives can be identified by their endings. Typical adjective endings include:
- able/-ible **pliable**, *illegible*,
- -al **cynical, proverbial, tactical**
- -ful **dreadful, scornful**
- -ic **bombastic, eclectic, erratic**
- -ive **effusive, elusive, incisive**
- -less *breathless, careless,*
groundless, restless
- -ous **abstemious, bodacious,**
contentious

Helpful Hints

- So look at the word if it is an adjective, the synonym must be one that describes something.
- If the word is a verb, look for a synonym that shows an action.
- And if the word is a noun, then look for the synonym that tells of a person, place, or thing.

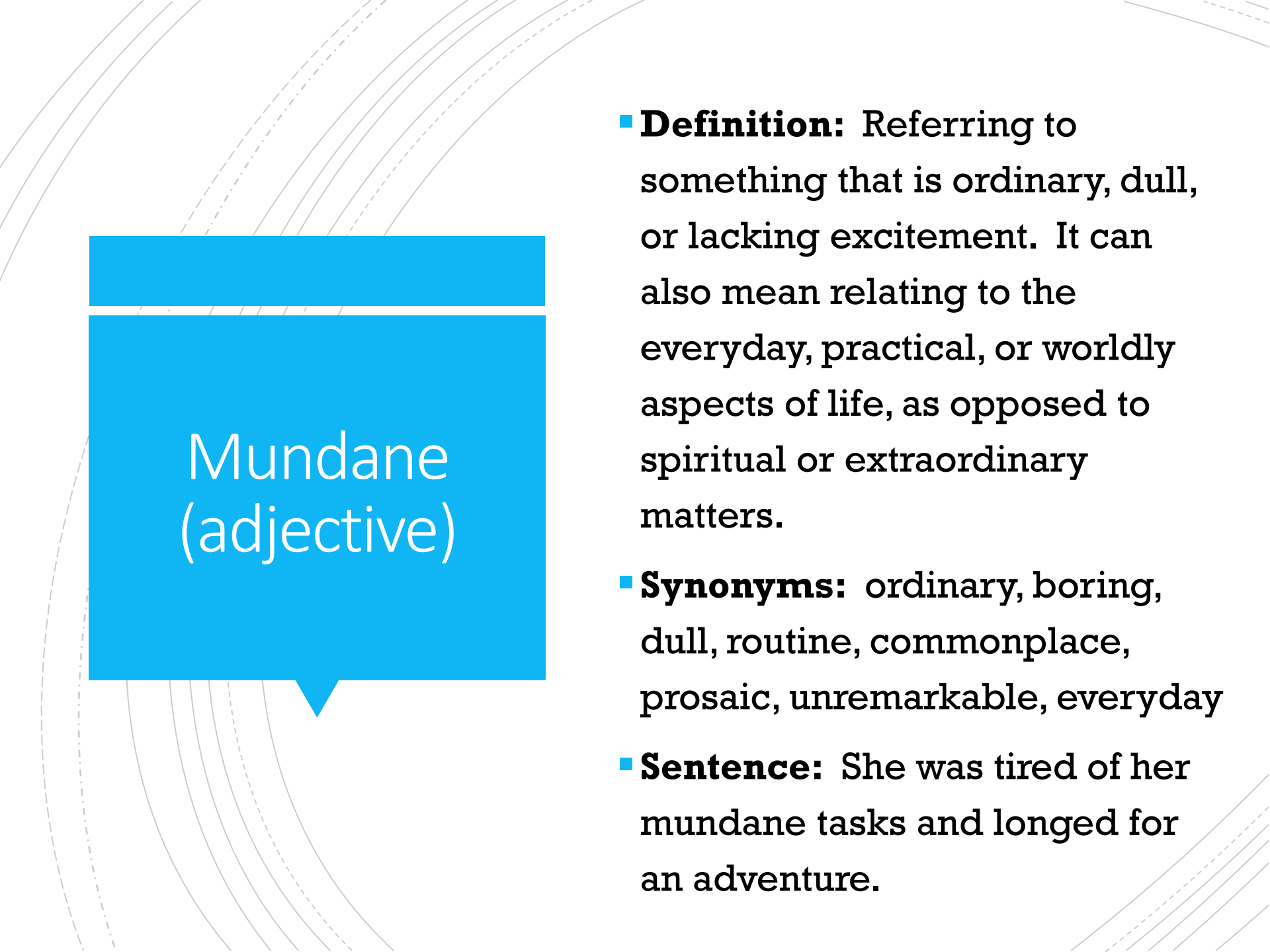
Extra Vocabulary Words for the N-V-A Quizzes

BSEP English

Dr. Bullock

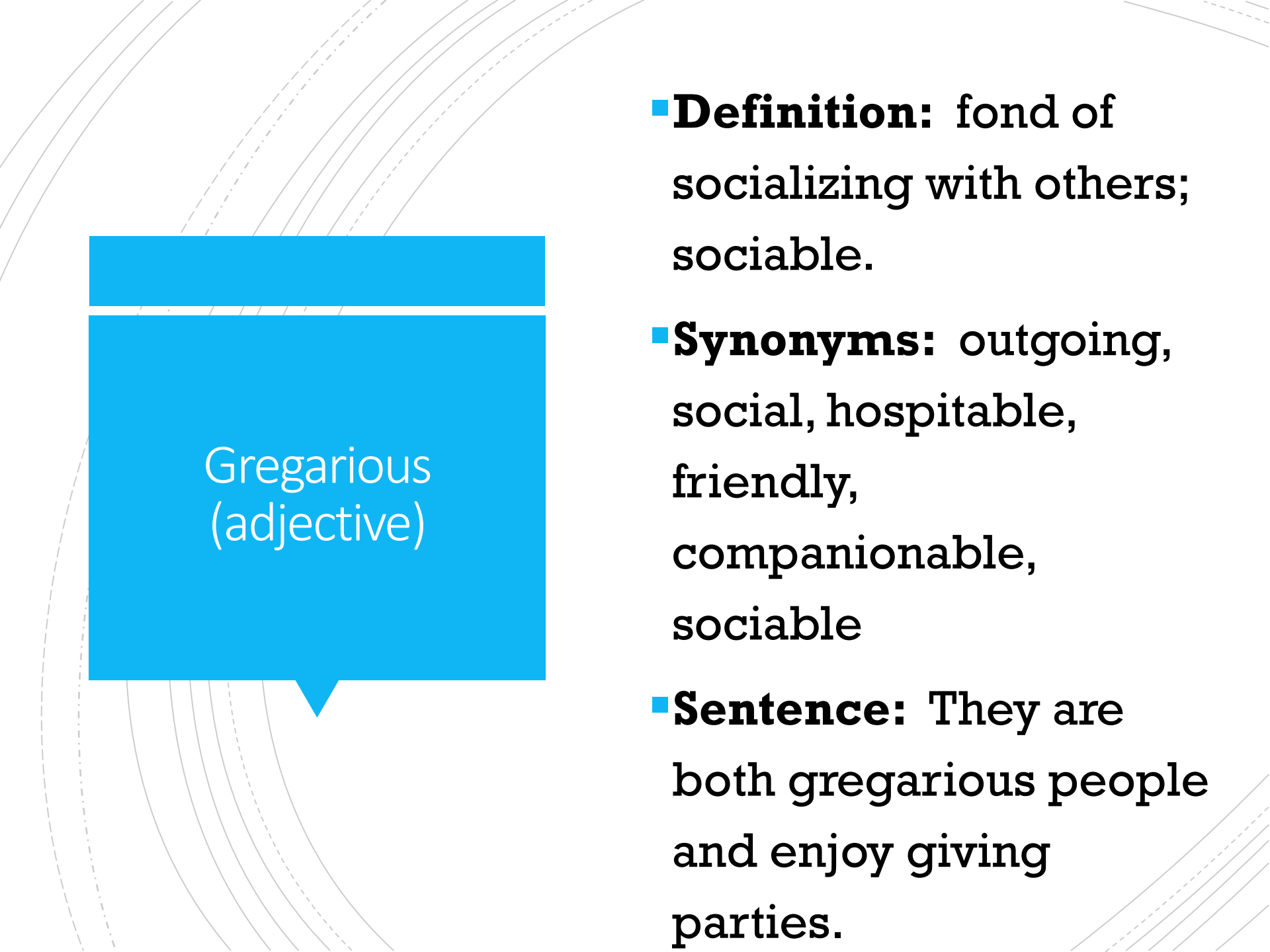
Abstemious	Flagrant
Jargon	Imminent
Jubilant	Destitution
Erratic	Coroner
Gawk	Lambaste
Frolic	Hypocrisy
Infiltrate	Green
Perilous	Gregarious
Agile	Impetuous
Invigorate	Makeshift
Inept	Nepotism
Illusion	Moratorium
Demoralized	Omen
Decry	Pretentious
Ubiquitous	Mundane
Fame	Lewd
Skepticism	Feign
Communique'	

Halt		Kink	
Latent		Enclosure	
Deciphered		Qualm	
Terse		Soluble	
Reciprocate		Decorum	
Hindrance		Diminish	
Fervor		Screech	
Writhe		Schism	
Scornful		Obvious	
Lewd			
Virulent		Deplete	
Petrify		Savor	
Feign		Ouster	
Mammoth		Sham	
Prestige		Loathing	
Maroon		Snarl	
Phenomenon		Plummet	
Yearn		Zenith	



Mundane (adjective)

- **Definition:** Referring to something that is ordinary, dull, or lacking excitement. It can also mean relating to the everyday, practical, or worldly aspects of life, as opposed to spiritual or extraordinary matters.
- **Synonyms:** ordinary, boring, dull, routine, commonplace, prosaic, unremarkable, everyday
- **Sentence:** She was tired of her mundane tasks and longed for an adventure.

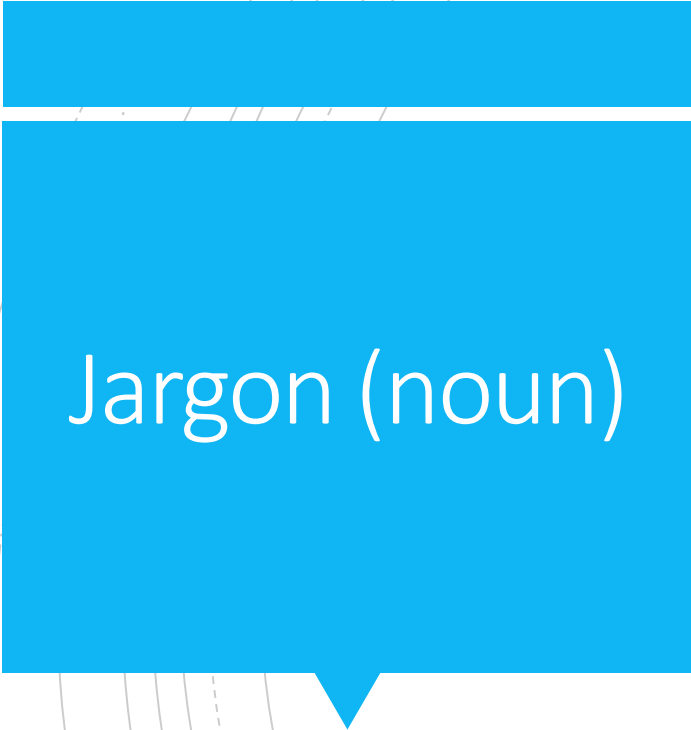


Gregarious
(adjective)

- **Definition:** fond of socializing with others; sociable.
- **Synonyms:** outgoing, social, hospitable, friendly, companionable, sociable
- **Sentence:** They are both gregarious people and enjoy giving parties.

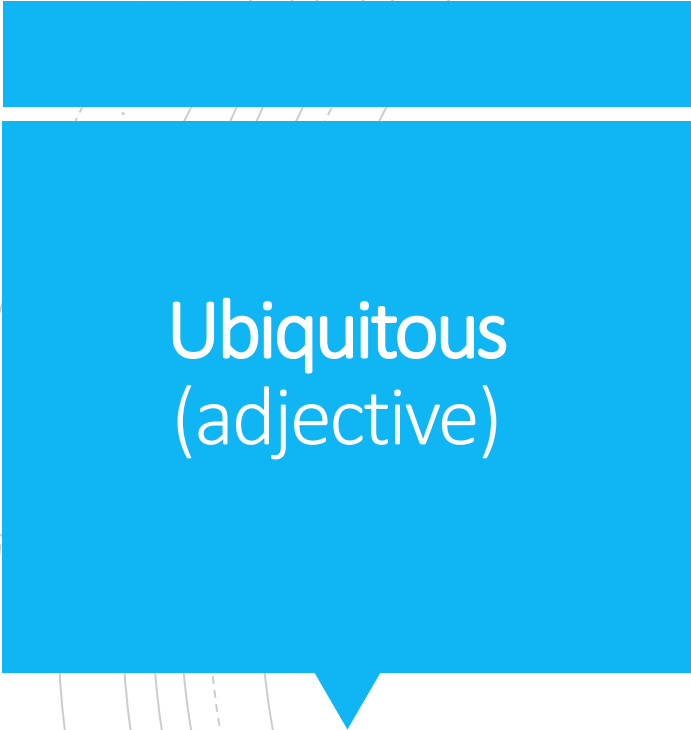
Jubilant
(adjective)

- **Definition:** feeling or expressing great happiness and triumph; having or showing great joy; having a happy feeling of success.
- **Synonyms:** overjoyed, excited, thrilled, glad, elated, triumphant, exuberant, euphoric, ecstatic, joyful
- **Sentence:** The jubilant team hugged each other after their win.



Jargon (noun)

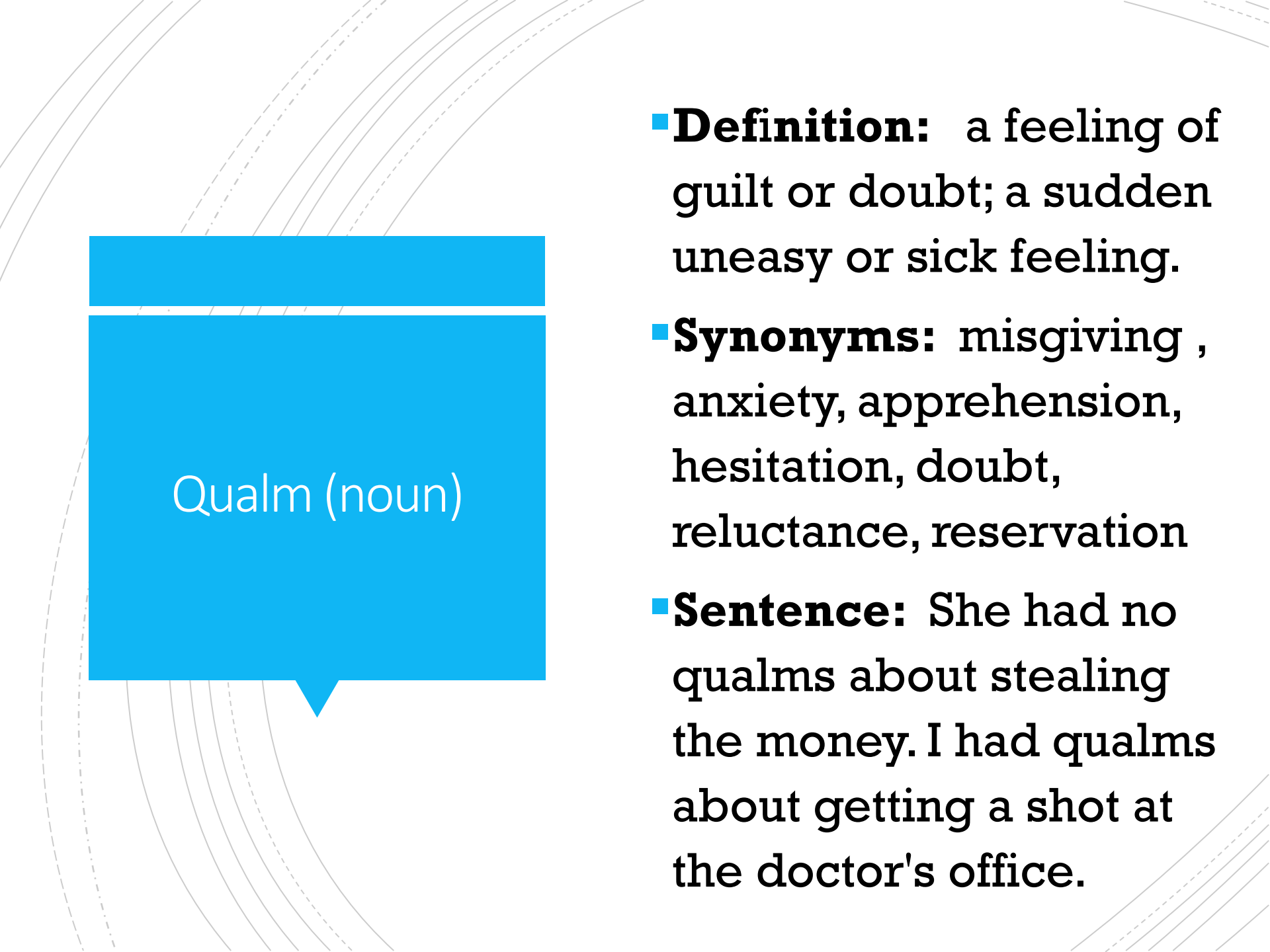
- **Definition:** It is a specialized language used by a particular group, profession, or field, often difficult for outsiders to understand. It can also refer to language that is unnecessarily complicated or pretentious.
- **Synonyms:** terminology, lingo, argot, slang, cant, dialect, vernacular, idiom
- **Sentence:** The legal document was filled with jargon that made it hard for laypeople to understand.



Ubiquitous (adjective)

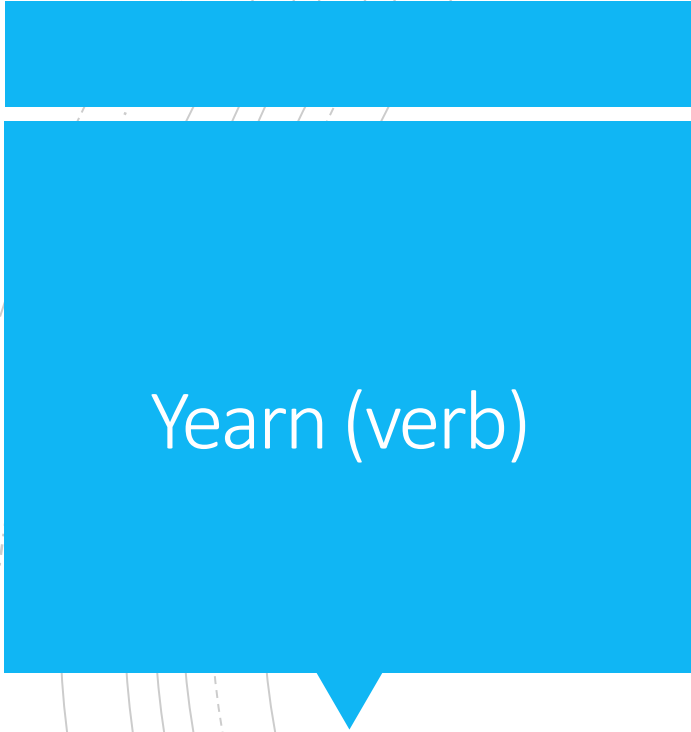
- **Definition:** means present, appearing, or found everywhere. It refers to something that is widespread or seems to be encountered everywhere.
- **Synonyms:** Omnipresent, Pervasive, Universal, Widespread, Ever-present
- **Sentence:** With the rise of smartphones, wireless internet has become so **ubiquitous** that it's almost impossible to find a place without Wi-Fi.

■



Qualm (noun)

- **Definition:** a feeling of guilt or doubt; a sudden uneasy or sick feeling.
- **Synonyms:** misgiving , anxiety, apprehension, hesitation, doubt, reluctance, reservation
- **Sentence:** She had no qualms about stealing the money. I had qualms about getting a shot at the doctor's office.

A blue speech bubble graphic with a white border, containing the text 'Yearn (verb)'. The bubble has a tail pointing towards the bottom left.

Yearn (verb)

- **Definition:** to long persistently, wistfully, or sadly; to have a strong desire, craving, or wish for something.
- **Synonyms:** long, pine, crave, desire, want, agonize, pant
- **Sentences:** He yearned for freedom. Allowed little freedom, she yearned for excitement.



Zenith (noun)

- **Definition:** the highest point; peak; the time at which something is most powerful or successful; the point in the sky that is directly over the head of the person looking at it.
- **Synonyms:** highest point, pinnacle, culmination, peak, apex
- **Sentence:** The sun rises, reaches its zenith and sets.

Important Resources

Read Theory – Required use (20 minutes daily). Go to this website www.readtheory.org, create your free student account, once you have done that, log into your account, and complete the assessment quiz by clicking on I'm ready to create your study material based on your results by your academic level upon entering BSEP.

Kahoot.com (Interactive Quiz Game to help learn the new vocabulary words). Create your free student account. Log into Kahoot using your login information. On your mobile app press the discover at the bottom of the screen. Then put in the search box bullockk118 to gain access to study material for the word knowledge. Press view all and scroll down to classic solo to start the quiz. (Kahoot will talk/pronounce the words for you, allow you to use study mode with the flash cards, host a quiz to use to study with a friend or group, and so much more.)